Enterprise Planning Transformation: From Intake to Engineering Commitment

Role: Planning transformation lead | Process redesign, cross-functional alignment, governance and capacity-informed prioritization

Executive summary

I helped redesign a large-scale engineering planning process that had grown into a lengthy, high-rework cycle. After mapping the end-to-end value stream, I worked with engineering, product and central planning stakeholders to introduce intake quality gates, earlier dependency alignment, time-boxed sizing and clearer capacity-based trade-offs. The transformation reduced the planning cycle from approximately 55 to 25 working days (reported outcome), while simplifying mandatory intake fields by approximately 80%.

Scale and outcomes

55 → 25	~55%	80%	800–900
Working days per planning cycle	Reduction in cycle time	Fewer mandatory intake fields	Domain projects per cycle

Cycle-time reduction is calculated from the reported 55-day baseline and 25-day outcome: (55−25)/55 ≈ 54.5%. The 800–900 figure describes domain-level planning volume, not projects individually handled by one TPM.

The operating problem

Roadmap planning involved multiple rounds of intake review, dependency discovery, engineering estimation, reconciliation and executive cutlines. Missing requirements caused rework, late dependency discovery shifted sizing assumptions, and end-of-cycle governance concentrated decisions too late. A value-stream map documented approximately 55 working days from intake to commitment.

Before: where the time went

Intake	Review	Sizing	Recon.	Cutlines
5d	10d	15d	10d	15d

55 working days total | late-stage reconciliation and cutline decisions

Redesign: shift quality and decisions earlier

Gate 0 — capacity baseline: Validate available engineering capacity and distinguish funded capacity from unconfirmed assumptions.

Gate A — intake quality: Require essential requirements, business outcomes and initial dependency signals before detailed sizing.

Joint shaping: Bring product, engineering and TPM stakeholders together earlier to resolve ambiguity.

Gate B — sizing readiness: Use time-boxed effort ranges, assumptions and confidence rather than repeated late-stage estimates.

Gate C — commit confidence: Make dependency ownership, critical path and readiness visible before portfolio cutlines.

A documented future-state value-stream design targeted approximately 28 working days. That figure was a design target in the process map; the 25-day result above is the separately reported transformation outcome, not a value measured in that map.

How the New Planning System Worked

End-to-end planning flow



Quality checks before commitment; capacity and dependencies inform trade-offs

The TPM decisions behind the transformation

Decision	Rationale
Reduce friction	Removed unnecessary mandatory intake fields while retaining information needed to make credible decisions.
Surface trade-offs	Compared engineering demand with capacity to identify overloaded teams and support scope or sequencing decisions.
Avoid late surprises	Shifted dependency and estimate conversations earlier, reducing the need for end-stage reconciliation.
Make governance useful	Defined clear intake and commitment criteria, with ownership and confidence rather than binary status alone.
Coordinate across organizations	Aligned product, engineering, program teams and central planning on the revised workflow.

Capacity-informed prioritization

Instead of treating a roadmap as a flat list of requests, planning decisions considered team availability, estimated engineering effort, shared dependencies and the relative priority of competing initiatives. This created a practical mechanism for leadership to choose what to commit, defer, resize or re-sequence.

Results and business impact

Faster planning: approximately 30 working days removed from the cycle, from 55 to 25 days (~55% reduction).

Simpler intake: approximately 80% fewer mandatory fields, reducing submission friction and unnecessary administrative work.

Better decision quality: earlier visibility into engineering dependencies, capacity constraints, sizing confidence and readiness at commit.

More predictable handoff: explicit planning gates and execution-readiness criteria helped connect portfolio decisions to engineering delivery.

My contribution

I analyzed the existing planning workflow, mapped bottlenecks and rework loops, proposed a redesigned gate-based process, partnered with central planning and engineering leadership, and helped operationalize capacity-informed planning and decision governance. The transformation was cross-functional; I did not build or deliver it alone.